

Displaced Aggression Cat Survival Guide

— Action Checklist

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BEDROOM DOOR SECURITY

- ❑ **Bedroom Door Security:** Assess your bedroom door tonight for every vulnerability your cat could exploit, including gaps underneath, ability to open the latch, and any squeeze-through spaces, then address at least one gap before you sleep to create an effective nighttime barrier.
- ❑ **Bedroom Door Security:** Install a heavy-duty rubber door sweep on your bedroom door to close the gap underneath that your cat might squeeze through, and to provide audible feedback when your cat paws at the door during the night.
- ❑ **Bedroom Door Security:** Add a secondary barrier such as a baby gate with opaque covers or a tension rod with a heavy curtain in your bedroom doorway, creating a buffer zone that prevents your cat from seeing you through the door and reduces their arousal at closed barriers.
- ❑ **Bedroom Door Security:** Test your bedroom door lock to confirm it holds firmly when closed and cannot be manipulated open by your cat's paws or nose, because a failed lock during the night leaves you completely vulnerable during a sleep state.

PANIC ROOM PREPARATION

- ❑ **Panic Room Preparation:** Identify one lockable room in your home such as a bathroom or small bedroom to designate as your cat-free panic room, choosing a space you can reach within 30 seconds when you sense a displaced aggression episode beginning.
 - ❑ **Panic Room Preparation:** Place a small flashlight, your phone charger, and a pair of thick slippers inside your designated panic room so you can navigate safely and call for help if a nighttime attack requires extended retreat.
 - ❑ **Panic Room Preparation:** Test the lock on your panic room door to ensure it holds firmly when engaged, because a malfunctioning lock during a high-arousal episode leaves you trapped with no escape route in your most vulnerable moments.
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- **Panic Room Preparation:** Position elevated seating or standing space in your panic room since cats lose their ambush advantage when their target is above floor level, making it harder for a highly aroused cat to attack you effectively from a height.

ATTACK RESPONSE TOOLS

- **Attack Response Tools:** Keep a thick blanket or towel within arm's reach of your bed to throw over your cat during a sudden attack, which breaks their visual focus and buys you 10 to 15 critical seconds to reach your panic room.
- **Attack Response Tools:** Place a spray bottle filled with water at your bedside as a non-painful way to create distance during an attack, allowing you to interrupt a lunging cat without triggering additional fear-based escalation that worsens future episodes.
- **Attack Response Tools:** Store a can of compressed air near your bed for longer-range defense against an attacking cat, as it creates distance without visible threat and without causing the kind of pain that amplifies neurological arousal over time.
- **Attack Response Tools:** Keep your phone fully charged and within reach of your bed at night so you can call emergency services or a support person if a severe attack occurs and you need assistance to safely exit the room.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.